Grant No. 10CH010719

Table of Contents

1. Overview
2. Plan to expand and improve nutrition services and support for healthy eating
3. Budget Narrative, including Non-Federal Share
4. Timeline for Implementation
5. Summary

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1. Overview

Background

An original 1965 grantee, Portland Public Schools Head Start is currently funded for 648 children. Our service area is PPS school district boundaries, east of the Willamette River in Portland, Oregon. We have 49 full day classrooms across Portland's most impacted neighborhoods – North Portland, SE Portland, St. Johns, Cully, Foster-Powell, and Montavilla – where rates of food insecurity and housing instability are some of highest in Multnomah County. While USDA Child Nutrition programs provide essential meal support to our program, these resources do not cover access to local farms, family engagement around healthy eating, or specialized professional support needed to close persistent nutrition gaps.

Program Need

Our annual Community Needs Assessment highlights growing disparities in food access, rising food insecurity, and ongoing environmental health risks. The data indicates 1 in 6 children in Multnomah County are food insecure. Only 85% of those eligible for SNAP are enrolled, with the greatest need concentrated in neighborhoods within our service area (St. Johns, Cully, Foster-Powell, and Montavilla). National data also indicates that low-income households – like the families we serve in Head Start – are significantly more likely to experience food insecurity and rely on calorie-dense, nutrient-poor options (USDA ERS, 2023). Additionally, many PPS families live in older homes with elevated lead exposure risk – particularly in Kenton, Cully, and Mt. Tabor — further undermining children's health and development. Without targeted support, these patterns can contribute to poor diet quality, higher rates of childhood obesity, and increased risk of chronic disease later in life.

This is evident in our specific student population. Our 2025 Program Information Report (PIR) Body Mass Index (BMI) data indicates that 16% of our students are categorized as overweight and 19% categorized as obese, with the latter reflecting a 5% increase from the previous school year. In addition, 3.3% of enrolled students are

categorized as underweight, indicating that a portion of our population is experiencing undernutrition, which can negatively affect growth, development, and learning. To normalize BMIs and address both ends of the malnutrition spectrum, our children need increased opportunities to integrate physical activity, nutrition, and wellness into daily routines. This includes health literacy on nutrition, physical wellness and movement activities to equip families with tools to build lifelong healthy habits.

Our families are strong advocates for improving children's access to nutrient-dense foods and reducing reliance on ultra-processed items high in added sugars. In March 2024, our Parent Policy Council submitted a formal letter to PPS Nutrition Services requesting that the program expand fresh fruit and vegetable offerings during snack and replace packaged, processed foods with whole-food alternatives. Families have also voiced a desire for nutritious food options at family engagement events, along with workshops focused on nutrition and healthy eating. At the same time, many parents report barriers to accessing food assistance due to limited availability outside standard work hours, and the closure of several site-based food pantries has further widened the nutrition gap. Together, these requests and challenges highlight the urgent need for program-level improvements that make fresh, healthy foods consistently accessible for children and families while also equipping parents with the knowledge and resources to support healthier eating habits at home.

While our children need nutrient-rich food and families continue to champion healthy eating, PPS Head Start faces complex, compounding barriers. Limited access to affordable, high-quality food disproportionately affects our enrolled families, many of whom live in food deserts or food swamps where convenience stores and fast-food outlets far outnumber grocery stores with fresh produce. Under-resourced households face financial strain, long or irregular work hours, and limited transportation, all of which make it harder to prioritize healthy food purchasing and preparation. The closure of site-based food pantries and reduced access to emergency food supports further exacerbate these challenges. Additionally, systemic inequities—including the rising cost of groceries and lack of culturally relevant food options—have widened gaps in access to fresh, healthy food. Taken together, these barriers create a cycle where children are more likely to consume ultra-processed foods, increasing their risk of obesity, undernutrition, and long-term health concerns.

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2. Plan to expand and improve nutrition services and support for healthy eating

Funding Category: Food Service Upgrades

Goal 1: PPS Head Start will expand long-term access to fresh, healthy, and local food.

> **Activity**: We will establish vendor contracts with local farms for the procurement of local, seasonally fresh food items. Procurement will include transportation costs for delivering seasonally fresh ingredients to centers on early release days when we do not provide a snack component to our students. Our Registered Dietitian will oversee the quality of local food sources and ensure the fruits and vegetables are nutrient dense; the dietitian will also work with nutrition services to integrate

ongoing sustainability practices. Our Business Operations Analyst will maintain and document procedures to comply with federal procurement guidelines.

Rationale: Partnering with local farms and distributors through formal vendor agreements increases reliable access to fresh, seasonal produce and supports nutrient-rich menus year-round (USDA FNS, 2024; CDC, 2023). Supplementing processed snacks with fruits, vegetables, and whole grains improves nutrient intake, lowers added sugar consumption, and promotes children's healthy growth while modeling positive nutrition habits for families (CDC, 2022; CATCH Program Study, 2013).

Funding Category 2: Materials, Supplies, and Equipment

Goal 2: PPS Head Start will improve the safety and quality of food preparation.

Activity: We will purchase food safe storage supplies to improve the safety of food preparation and quality of family style dining in our classrooms. Our Registered Dietitian will ensure supplies meet federal food-safe specifications and our Business Operations Analyst will maintain and document procedures to comply with federal procurement guidelines.

Rationale: Outdated materials can contribute to longer preparation times, inconsistent meal quality, reduced food safety, and higher costs, ultimately reducing the efficiency and safety of food service operations (National Food Service Management Institute, 2019). Updating kitchen supplies is essential to delivering high-quality, nutritious meals that align with USDA Food and Nutrition guidelines and Head Start Program Performance Standards.

Goal 3: PPS Head Start will create community gardens at four program sites.

Activity: We will partner with Growing Gardens, a local nonprofit, to procure materials and supplies to install community gardens at 4 of our sites. Growing Gardens has nearly 30 years of experience growing foods with families, children, and school communities to build nourishing whole food systems. The Growing Gardens contract will include supplies design, installation, and local support of procurement. Garden spaces with raised beds, greenhouses, and Indigenous seed hubs; training will also be provided to staff to ensure long–term sustainability of gardens and integration of whole food into education programming.

Rationale: Community gardens serve as living classrooms that engage children in hands-on food exploration, increase produce consumption, and encourage family participation in healthier eating (Journal of the Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics, 2020; Urban Agriculture Review, 2022). By investing in sustainable infrastructure — such as garden kits, greenhouse supplies, and Indigenous seed hubs — PPS Head Start can embed culturally relevant food education and traditional growing practices into its curriculum for long-term impact (Farm to School Network, 2021).

Funding Category 3: Nutrition Education Resources

Goal 4: PPS Head Start will establish staff and family-centered nutrition education programs.

Activity: We will partner with Greater NW Community Health Collective (GNWCHC) to offer integrated health education, resource navigation, and culturally relevant support to our families. GNWCHC will offer 4 neighborhood pop-up nutrition fairs that include educational resources and family engagement activities. They will also offer 5 nutrition workshops to support long-term positive healthy eating habits that empower families, and when applicable, assisting families in enrolling in farmers market vouchers to reinforce learning and increase access to healthy food at home. Lastly, the GNWCHC Community Health Team will also provide outreach, navigation, and transportation support to families connecting them to a variety of essential, healthy food access points (ie grocery stores, farmers markets, food pantries, etc.)

Activity: To extend the impact and ensure the sustainability of our community gardens (see Funding Category 2, Goal 3), Growing Gardens will also provide programming to our families, students, and staff. Growing Gardens will facilitate 2 workshops per site over 12 months. Workshops will center around gardening, garden-based nutrition, and cooking education to build connections. Growing Gardens will also enroll at least 8 PPS Head Start Staff into their nationally recognized School Garden Coordinator Certificate Training (SGCCT) to increase staff leadership skillsets for making educational connections and food production beyond the successful use of one-time funding.

Rationale: Evidence from nutrition education programs like SNAP-Ed and Cooking Matters programs shows that hands-on workshops focused on meal preparation, budget shopping, and healthy cooking increase participants' cooking confidence, food resource management skills, and consumption of fruits and vegetables (SNAP-Ed Connection, 2022; Cooking Matters Evaluation, 2021). Healthy nutrition is essential for brain development and provides children with the energy needed to stay active and focused throughout the Head Start day. Hosting nutrition fairs and workshops will allow PPS Head Start families to build practical skills they can immediately home.

Collaborating with trusted local partners such as Growing Gardens and Greater Northwest Health Collective strengthens program reach and ensures that resources reflect community needs. Research confirms that partnerships between early learning programs and community-based organizations improve family engagement and help reduce disparities in access to health education and support services (Annie E. Casey Foundation, 2020).

Funding Category 4: Non-recurring Personnel Fees

Goal 5: PPS Head Start will develop programming to integrate physical activity into children's daily routines.

Activity: We will partner with Soccer Shots, a local youth soccer program, to provide 5 weeks of soccer programming to our Head Start students at school this year. PPS Head Start established a partnership with Soccer Shots in the Spring of 2024 when they offered programming to our students 100% in kind. Continuing this programming will deliver life changing opportunities for our kids to be active, to learn from coaches, work with their peers, and develop gross motor skills. Soccer Shots and PPS will research additional funding sources to continue this model beyond the contract.

Rationale: Collaborations with organizations like Soccer Shots enable the integration of physical activity and wellness into daily routines, complementing nutrition efforts.Our data indicates that our students' BMI is a significant program need. Research links combined nutrition and physical activity programs to healthier body mass index (BMI), improved motor skills, and overall wellness in early childhood (Preventing Chronic Disease, 2020; National Institutes of Health, 2021).

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3. Budget Narrative

Budget Summary

Total Direct	**$579,048**
Total Indirect Rate	**$24,877**
Total Grant Request	**$603,925**
Total Matching	**$165,820**
Total (all sources)	**$769,835**

Budget Details

Budget Categories	Activity	Grant Cost	Matching
A. Personnel	n/a	$0	n/a
B. Fringe	n/a	$0	n/a
C. Travel	n/a	$0	n/a

D. Equipment	n/a	$0	n/a
E. Supplies	Food Safe Storage Supplies	$25,000	
F. Contractual	Registered Dietitian (RD) Farms for Seasonally Fresh Snacks Growing Gardens GNWCHC Soccer Shots	$34,800 $43,328 $250,000 $200,000 $25,920	$16,825 (match) $61,225 (in kind) $48,890 (in kind) $38,880 (in kind)
G. Construction	n/a	$0	n/a
H. Other	n/a	$0	n/a
I. Total Direct Charges		**$579,048**	**$165,820**
J. Indirect Charges	PPS rate 4.49%	**$24,877**	

Expense Descriptions

A. Personnel (Salaries and Wages) _____ Total: $0

B. Fringe & Health Insurance _____ Total: $0

C. Travel _____ Total: $0

D. Equipment _____ Total: $0

E. Supplies _____ Total: $25,000

Food Safe Storage Supplies

Total: $25,000
PPS Head Start programs require durable, food-grade dry storage systems to ensure food safety and maintain the quality of ingredients. Airtight containers and labeled, transparent bins prevent contamination, extend shelf life, and support compliance with USDA and CDC guidelines for safe food handling. NSF-certified shelving provides organized, hygienic storage that is easy to clean and reduces the risk of pests or spoilage. The Registered Dietician will conduct a needs assessment of program site kitchens to identify specific supplies and procure supplies within a 12 month period. *Food Safe storage items (ie. dry storage containers, dry storage shelving, produce/dry goods bins, tin foil, and/or reusable options) = $25,000*

F. Contractual _____ Total: $554,048

Contract – Registered Dietitian (RD)

Total: $51,625
Consultation of RD is required for the implementation of Grant Goal 1 (expand long-term access to fresh, healthy, and local food), Goal 2 (improve the safety and quality of food preparation), and Goal 3 (create community gardens at four program sites). The RD will provide expertise and program management of these activities to meet the specific needs of children and improve student health outcomes across the program. The RD will oversee activities in these goals areas over a 12-month project period. ***Federal Supplemental Grant: $34,800*** ● *Project Management = $34,800* ○ *400 hours over 12 month project period | RD Rate = $87/hour*
Non-Federal Share: $16,825 ● *Technology + software = $1600* ● *Project Management = $15,225* ○ *175 hours over 12 month project period | RD Rate = $87/hour* The match will come from our PPS (non-federal) General Education Fund. We will allocate the corresponding dollar amount to each funding source. When invoicing is received we will allocate to the corresponding funding source ensuring that the same costs are not counted toward any other award. Tracking is done via a Contract Approval Form where funding source and total allocation are indicated. This ensures that no over payment is done on either funding source.

Contract – Farms for Seasonally Fresh Snacks

Total costs = $43,328
Procurement of seasonally fresh fruits and vegetables from local farms is required to meet Grant Goal 1 (expand long-term access to fresh, healthy, and local food). Contract(s) will be established with local farmer(s) who grow food locally and are able to deliver fresh fruits and vegetables to our 14 Head Start sites monthly for a 12 month project period. ● *Estimated snack Component = $4 x 648 Head Start students x 9 months = $23,328* ● *Estimated farm administrative, operational, and delivery costs = $20,000*

Contract – Growing Gardens

Total: $311,225
A partnership with Growing Gardens is necessary to meet Grant Goal 2 (create community gardens at four program sites) and Grant Goal 4 (staff and family-centered nutrition education programs) to increase access to healthy, nutritious and whole foods. Scope of work for 12 month period will include: *Scope of work for 12 month period for community gardens will include:* ● *Needs assessment process to understand what is needed at garden sites* ● *Planning process for each space and procurement of materials* ● *Garden builds in in March, April, October or November to align with the growing seasons* *Scope of work for 12 month period for staff and family programming will include:* ● *Plan, coordinate and lead 2 quarterly workshops per site to align with the seasonal calendar* ● *Enroll at least 8 PPS Headstart staff into our nationally recognized School Garden Coordinator Certificate Training (SGCCT)* ***Federal Supplemental Grant = $250,000*** ● *Garden design, installation, workshops, local support of procurement and staffing = $216,800* ● *Irrigation = $15,000* ● *Indoor/greenhouse equipment & Indigenous seed hub materials = $15,000* ● *Enrollment into the SGCTT 8 participants = $3,200*
In-Kind Share: $61,225 ● *Garden materials costs: lumber, soil, seeds, plants, etc.* ● *Workshop materials costs: printing, materials, etc.* ● *Volunteer time to support time* ● *Operating costs* *Growing Gardens has confirmed they will provide a 20% in-kind match. See attached documentation.* *Contractors will be required to track donated goods, services, and/or volunteer hours with the PPS Head Start Gift-in-Kind Tracking Form. All in-kind contributions must include a fair-market-value proof (quote, catalog price, photos) in alignment with federal cost principles and to ensure that all in-kind contributions are properly recorded and auditable. PPS Head Start will provide an acknowledgment letter to the donor after their contribution has been received. The program will maintain detailed logs of in-kind contributions; this will be verified monthly for accuracy, appropriate grant allocations, and compliance with federal guidelines.*

Contract – Greater Northwest Community Health Collective (GNWCHC)

Total: $248,890
*A health and nutrition partnership with GNWCHC is necessary to meet Grant Goal 4 (*establish a family-centered nutrition education program) *to ensure all families and children in our program have safe, reliable, and affordable access to healthy food. Scope of work for 12 month period will include:* ● *Two FTE Community Health Workers (CHWs) provide community centered outreach, navigation, and transportation support for families to access grocery stores, farmers markets, farmers stands, etc.* ● *Four neighborhood pop-up nutrition fairs, offering educational resources and family engagement activities.* ● *Five nutrition workshops to support long-term positive healthy eating habits* ● *Enrollment assistance to access essential state benefits, when applicable.*
Federal Supplemental Grant = $200,000 ● *$155,000 for two full-time Community Health Workers (CHWs)* ● *$45,000 in operational costs:* ○ *$10,000 for technology infrastructure, data tracking systems, marketing and program evaluation to ensure quality, transparency, and scalability.* ○ *$5,000 for routine van maintenance, seasonal tire changes, repairs, and upkeep for reliable service.* ○ *$15,000 for community nutrition and health outreach events and engagement.* ○ *$15,000 for workshop materials, stipends, snacks, food, and drinks.*
In-Kind Share: $48,890 ● *Volunteering staff* ● *Leadership hours to prepare and facilitate family and community engagements* ● *Training materials and equipment for sustainability planning post contract* *Contractors will be required to track donated goods, services, and/or volunteer hours with the PPS Head Start Gift-in-Kind Tracking Form. All in-kind contributions must include a fair-market-value proof (quote, catalog price, photos) in alignment with federal cost principles and to ensure that all in-kind contributions are properly recorded and auditable. PPS Head Start will provide an acknowledgment letter to the donor after their contribution has been received. The program will maintain detailed logs of in-kind contributions; this will be verified monthly for accuracy, appropriate grant allocations, and compliance with federal guidelines.*

Contract – Soccer Shots

Total: $64,800
A partnership with Soccer Shots is necessary to meet Grant Goal 5 (integrate physical activity into children's daily routines). Soccer Shots Coaches will lead soccer classes at our 14 sites for a 5 week season. Classes include materials for class, physical activities (soccer fundamentals like dribbling, passing, shooting), mindfulness games, and include the classroom teachers so activities can be replicated in future classroom learning. The scope of work will be completed within a 12 month period. ***Federal Supplemental Cost = $25,920*** ● *$8 per class x 648 Head Start students = $5,184* ● *$5184 x 5 week season = $25,920*
Soccer Shots has confirmed they will provide an in-kind match. Soccer Shots has committed to paying 60 percent of class costs for Head Start students. The Soccer Shots standard rate is $20 dollars per class; however, Soccer Shots will contribute 12 dollars per student at Head Start, lowering the cost to 8 dollars per class. This significantly reduces the cost to children and the Head Start program. *See attached documentation.* ***In-Kind Cost = $38,880*** ● *$12 per class x 648 Head Start students = $5,184* ● *$5184 x 5 week season = $25,920* *Contractors will be required to track donated goods, services, and/or volunteer hours with the PPS Head Start Gift-in-Kind Tracking Form. All in-kind contributions must include a fair-market-value proof (quote, catalog price, photos) in alignment with federal cost principles and to ensure that all in-kind contributions are properly recorded and auditable. PPS Head Start will provide an acknowledgment letter to the donor after their contribution has been received. The program will maintain detailed logs of in-kind contributions; this will be verified monthly for accuracy, appropriate grant allocations, and compliance with federal guidelines.*

G. Construction _____ Total: $0

H. Other _____ Total: $0

Financial and Property Management System

The PPS Head Start Program adheres to the District's financial management processes and procedures which, in turn, are governed by the Oregon Revised Statutes (ORS) and conform to Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP). Grant funds are tracked in the District's financial system in a separate fund for ease of visibility and tracking. An annual audit by an independent auditor is performed to grant funds of the District to the standards contained in

Government Auditing Standards issued by the Comptroller General of the United States. All grant documents from the Notice of Award to the final SF425 report are kept on file both at the Head Start administrative office and at the District's finance offices. Procurement processes are also governed by ORS and by District Board Policy. A record of equipment over $10,000 purchased with Federal Head Start funds is retained at the District office and is inventoried every other year by Head Start staff. Materials and technology inventory is kept at the Head Start administrative offices and is also inventoried biennially. All journal entries and reports initiated by the Head Start accountant are forwarded to the District accounting office where they are reviewed by the District grant accountant and approved by the accounting manager prior to posting to the general ledger.

Contracting

The PPS Head Start Program adheres to the District's contracting guidelines The District's purchasing and contracting activities are governed by Oregon Revised Statutes (primarily ORS 279A, ORS 279B and ORS 279C) and Board policy in the form of our PPS Public Contracting Rules, which are in turn modeled after the Attorney General's Model Public Contracting Rules.

Indirect Charges

Indirect charges are calculated at the end of the school district's fiscal year, once the year is closed. This usually happens between May – September. The calculations are submitted to the Oregon Department of Education for review and final approval. Once the indirect rates are approved, the District is notified of the final rate. This update includes the final state approved rate of 4.49% for the 2025–26 school year.

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4. Implementation Timeline

Project Phase (upon award)	Task / Activities	Responsible Staff	Status
Fresh Food Procurement & Vendor Partnerships			
Month 1-2	Meet with local farms and vendors to discuss contracts and establish delivery schedules	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Admin Asst.	
Month 3-4	Pilot fresh food deliveries at select sites; work with vendors to ramp up distribution	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Site Supervisors	
Months 5-8	Full-scale launch of seasonal food delivery program to all sites; monthly distribution	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Site Supervisors	
Months 9-12	Adjust deliveries based on family and staff feedback Secure long-term procurement agreements	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Site Supervisors	

	with vendors		
Food Safe Storage			
Month 1-3	Conduct site needs assessments and acquire supplies bids	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Admin Asst.	
Month 4-6	Finalize ordering plan and vendor selection	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Admin Asst.	
Months 7-9	Procure food-safe storage supplies	RD, Business Operations Analyst, Admin Asst.	
Months 10-12	Staff training on safe food handling and new equipment use Final inspection and sustainability plan for maintenance	RD, Site Supervisors, Nutrition Services	
Garden Installation			
Month 1-3	Planning, partner onboarding, needs assessments, project plan development	Contractor, RD, Director, Business Operations Analyst, Admin Asst.	
Month 1-3	Garden site assessments with Growing Gardens	Contractor, RD, Site Supervisors	
Month 4-6	Finalize garden plans and procure materials	Contractor, RD, Business Operations Analyst	
Months 7-9	Install garden beds, greenhouses, and Indigenous seed hubs	Contractor, RD, Admin Asst.	
Months 10-12	Launch parent-child garden programs and harvest events	Family Services Manager, RD	
Months 13-18	Evaluate garden yield and create sustainability plan	Family Services Manager, RD, Director, Business Operations Analyst, Admin Asst.	
Family Nutrition Education & Community Outreach			
Month 1-3	Partner onboarding, needs assessments, project plan development	Family Services Manager, Contractor, Community Engagement Coor., Business Operations Analyst	
Month 1-3	Plan annual Nutrition & Health Fairs with GNWCHC	Family Services Manager, Contractor, Community Engagement Coor., Business Operations Analyst	
Month 4-6	Host first 2 Nutrition & Health Fairs with cooking demos and screenings	Contractor, Family Services Manager, Community Engagement Coor., Business	

		Operations Analyst	
Months 13-8	Host final 2 Nutrition & Health Fairs; evaluate outcomes with GNWCHC	Contractor, Family Services Manager, Community Engagement Coor., Business Operations Analyst	
Movement & Physical Activity Programming			
Month 1-3	Soccer Shots onboarding, assess spaces, develop classroom/site schedules	Contractor, Director, Site Supervisors, Business Operations Analyst	
Months 4-12	Implement movement programming to all sites	Contractor, Community Engagement Coor., Site Supervisors, Teachers	
Months 13-18	Integrate physical activity into regular classroom routines	Contractor, Community Engagement Coor., Site Supervisors, Teachers	

5. Summary

PPS Head Start is committed to healthy children and families as we elevate our services to include long-term access to local, fresh, healthy food, nutrition education for students and families, and garden programming. With the addition of youth participation in healthy physical activity through a formal soccer program, PPS Head Start ensures a well-rounded program to improve the health and well-being of its youngest scholars.